

Allomone- Chemical communication between organisms which is positive for the sender and negative for the receiver.

Anaphylaxis- A severe allergic response in a vertebrate. In the worst case, “anaphylactic shock,” death may result.

Annual migration- Migration which occurs every year at a predictable time.

Anoplura- The order of insects containing the sucking lice.

Apterygota- Primitively wingless insect orders.

Asynchronous muscle- An insect muscle which contracts multiple times due to a single nerve impulse.

Biological disease transmission- The case in which the agent causing disease must pass some part of its lifecycle within the vectoring organism.

Bioluminescence- Light produced by a living organism.

Carnivorous plants- Plants that harvest insects and other arthropods to meet their demands for nitrogen and other nutrients.

Castes-Different body plans for different jobs, within the same species of eusocial insect.

Cochineal- Brilliant red dye produced by scale insects found on prickly pear cacti.

Communication- Exchange of information between two living organisms.

Communal insects- Species which aggregate during some phase of the lifecycle but do not maintain social contact throughout the lifecycle.

Delusional parasitosis- A condition in which the sufferer believes non-existent insects inhabit one's person.

Disease agent- An organism causing negative effects in another organism.

Direct flight muscles- major flight muscles directly attached to the bases of the wings.

Ectognatha- Hexapods with exposed mouthparts

Endopterygota- Insect orders which undergo complete metamorphosis.

Entognatha- Primitive insects with mouthparts hidden in the head.

Entomophagy- The practice of eating insects.

Entomophobia- An irrational fear of insects.

Eusocial insects- Species with cooperative brood care, reproductive division of labor, and perennial colonies with overlapping generations.

Exopterygota- Insect orders which undergo incomplete metamorphosis.

Forensic entomology- Using insects to understand crime scenes.

Ganglion- cluster of nerve cell bodies.

Heteroptera- An insect order containing the aphids, true bugs, and their allies. Includes the former Homoptera (aphids, etc.) which are all plant feeders, and the former Hemiptera (true bugs), which includes plant feeders, predators, and parasites.

Hexapod- An arthropod with six legs.

Indirect flight muscles- major flight muscles attached to the walls of the thorax rather than the bases of the wings

Isoptera- The insect order containing termites.

Kairomone- Chemical communication between organisms which is negative for the sender and positive for the receiver.

Locust- A large, often migratory, grasshopper

Luciferin- The chemical which produces, when combined with light, ATP, and the enzyme luciferinase, light in insects.

Mating disruption- Using pheromones to confuse pest insects so that they can't find each other to mate.

Mechanical disease transmission- The case where a disease agent is transmitted on the surface or in the mouthparts of the vectoring organism.

Migration- directional movement of large numbers of organisms

Myiasis- Parasitic infestation of living vertebrate tissue by larval flies.

Nomadic migration- Migration in any direction in response to the availability of resources.

Parasite- An organism which lives in, on, or near another organism at that organism's expense.

Pathogen- An organism causing disease in another.

Pheromone- chemical that facilitates communication between members of the same species.

Poikilothermic- an animal whose body temperature varies with that of the surrounding environment.

Pollination- Transfer of pollen (male germ cells) from one flower to the style and ovary of another flower, accomplishing fertilization.

Orthoptera- The hemimetabolous order of insects including grasshoppers and crickets. Forewings (if present) are leathery tegmina; hind legs modified for jumping. Chewing mouthparts.

Reservoir (disease)- An organism which sustains a disease agent on the landscape for long periods of time. Reservoirs are usually unaffected, or minimally affected, by the agent.

Resilin- Rubbery protein that stores energy in insect cuticle and muscle

Semisocial insects- Species with cooperative brood care and reproductive division of labor.

Shellac- Durable, high gloss furniture finish produced by an Asian scale insect.

Skeletal muscles- Those that move body parts of an insect.

Silk- Commercial product of the domesticated silkworm, *Bombus mori*. Produced by the salivary glands of the caterpillar as it spins its cocoon.

Solitary insects- Species which don't interact with others of their species except to mate or in response to resources.

Synchronous muscle- Muscle that contracts one time for a single nerve impulse

Stridulation- Sound produced by dragging a row of peg-like structures across a file-like structure.

Subsocial insects- Species in which a single female or a mated pair care for desert broods of immatures.

Surgical maggots- Fly larvae, raised in sterile conditions, used to remove necrotic (dead) tissue from wounds.

Thysanura- The primitively wingless insect order containing silverfish and their relatives. Three tail appendages, scaled bodies, can molt as adults (unlike virtually all other insects).

Trophylaxis- Sharing of gut contents between members of the same species, either through regurgitation or defecation.

Tymbal (or tympanum)- In insects, a thickened plate of chitin connected to powerful asynchronous muscles; deflection of the tymbal by the muscle produces sound. Typified by cicadas.

Urticating seta (“hairs”)- Stinging setae found on some insects, including some caterpillars

Vector- An organism transmitting a disease agent from an infected to an uninfected host.

Visceral muscles- Those that move the internal organs of an insect.